

Database Functions (Self-Learning)

Q. What is a User-Defined Function (UDF) in SQL? Explain how functions differ from Stored Procedures regarding parameters, return values, and execution contexts.

> **Definition to Remember**

1. Creating and Calling Functions

Creation: Must declare the return type explicitly.

Calling: Functions return a value, so they are embedded inside SQL NOT called via `CALL`.

2. Parameters and Return Values

- **Parameters:** Functions only accept **IN** parameters (input only no OUT or INOUT).

3. Procedures vs Functions

Feature	Stored Procedure	User-Defined Function
Can be called via CALL	Yes	No
Can return multiple values	Yes	No
Can be used in SQL statements	No	Yes
Can be used in triggers	Yes	No

> **Must-Write Points (for 10 marks)**

> **Quick Recall**

> `UD
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